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BON VOYAGE BY MARINA

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Scotland All-Inclusive Guide

Mystical Landscapes, Steam Trains & Stone-Lit Cities

June 21 – June 27 | Edinburgh, Highlands & Isle of Skye

From the haunted closes of Edinburgh's Old Town to the wind-brushed peaks of the Isle of Skye, this carefully curated journey blends storytelling, nature, and nostalgia. Follow the scent of fresh shortbread through cobbled lanes, ride the legendary Jacobite Steam Train across cinematic viaducts, and watch sunsets over the River Ness. Whether you're sipping whisky in a 19th-century church or wandering fairy-tale villages, this is Scotland in its richest, most magical form — all thoughtfully organized, one detail at a time.

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June 21 – Arrival in Edinburgh & Old Town Charm (Public Transport Edition)



Afternoon: Arrival & Hotel Check-in

Welcome to Edinburgh! After your **arrival at Waverley Station at 2:11 PM**, head to your hotel



Hotel: [Residence Inn by Marriott Edinburgh](#) 🚌 Public Transport: ~15 mins

Drop off your bags and get ready to step into Edinburgh's mysterious side.



Evening: Ghost Tour



Experience: *Old Town & Underground Ghost Tour*



Meeting Point: [124 High Street](#)



Time: 5:15 PM



Already purchased



~12 mins from your hotel by Bus

Expect eerie tales, haunted vaults, and a chillingly fun walk beneath the city's oldest streets.



After the Tour: Calton Hill & New Town

Next, head to [Calton Hill](#) — a short walk away.



Open 24/7 | 💰 Free

The views over Arthur's Seat, the North Sea, and the Edinburgh skyline are unforgettable.

Then take a gentle walk through [New Town](#), filled with neoclassical beauty and refined energy.



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Meals

Lunch (Pre-Tour, in city centre)

1. [The Chanter](#) – Sporty pub vibe, hearty portions

 10 AM – 5 PM |  £10–15

Best for: Quick Scottish pub fare

Dinner (Post-tour in New Town)

1. [Makars Mash Bar](#) – Scottish comfort food

 12 PM – 8:30 PM |  £15–20

 Must-try: Venison mash, haggis, whisky sauce

2. [Whiski Bar & Restaurant](#) – Whisky bar with live folk music

 10 AM – 1 AM |  £20–30

 Try: Cullen Skink, smoked salmon, cranachan



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June 22 – Edinburgh Castle & Cultural Delights



Morning: Edinburgh Castle

Start your day at the world-famous [Edinburgh Castle](#).



Entry: 11:30 AM (pre-booked)



Already purchased



~14 mins from hotel via Bus

Inside, discover the **Crown Jewels**, **Stone of Destiny**, and the oldest chapel in the city — **St. Margaret's Chapel**.



Midday: Royal Mile & St. Giles' Cathedral

After the castle, stroll down the storied [Royal Mile](#).

Step into [St. Giles' Cathedral](#), a marvel of gothic architecture.



Afternoon: Royal Botanic Garden Edinburgh

Next, visit the serene [Royal Botanic Garden](#).



10 AM – 5 PM |



Free



~17 mins via Bus from city centre

Take a peaceful stroll through themed gardens, glasshouses, and ancient trees.



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Meals

Lunch (Between Castle & Gardens)

1. [Maggie Dickson](#) (a cosy pub serving hearty meals, whisky and ale in an old-fashioned space with TVs.)
 11 AM – 1 PM |  £10- 20
 Try: fish and chips, burgers and nachos
2. [Footlights Bar and Grill](#) – Pub grub with local flavor
 12 PM – 11 PM |  £12–18
Best for: Burgers, fish & chips, casual seating
3. [The Milkman](#)- Cafe
 8 AM – 5 PM |  £1-10
Best for: Coffee

Dinner (New Town or Victoria Street)

1. [ASK Italian](#) – Stylish Italian chain
 11:30 AM – 10 PM |  £15–25
 Pizza Margherita, burrata, chocolate lava cake
 2. [Dishoom Edinburgh](#) – Bombay café vibe
 8 AM – 11 PM |  £25–30
 House black daal, okra fries, chai panna cotta
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June 23 – Harry Potter Magic & Dean Village Walk



Morning: Harry Potter Walking Tour

Today begins with a journey into the wizarding world! Join a [Harry Potter-themed walking tour](#) that whisks you through the cobbled alleys and real-world inspirations behind J.K. Rowling's world.



Tours typically last **2–4 hours**



Starting points vary but are often near [The Elephant House](#) or [Greyfriars Kirkyard](#)



From your hotel: ~15 mins via Bus into Old Town



Tip: Wear comfy shoes — there are lots of steps and stone walkways

Expect to see locations like:

- The café where Rowling wrote early drafts
 - Tom Riddle's grave
 - The real-life Diagon Alley (Victoria Street)
-



Afternoon: Dean Village & Water of Leith Walk

After your magical morning, switch gears with a tranquil, postcard-perfect stroll through [Dean Village](#).



~25 mins from Old Town via Bus 41 or 43 + 10-min walk



Best starting point: From the [Scottish National Gallery of Modern Art](#), take the scenic Water of Leith Walkway back toward the city

This peaceful neighborhood — once a grain milling village — feels like a portal to 19th-century Edinburgh. Highlights include:

- **Dean Bridge** for sweeping views
- **Well Court**, a fairy-tale courtyard
- **St. Bernard's Well**, a Roman temple-style structure by the river
- The leafy **Water of Leith Walkway**, perfect for slow wandering

Plan for **1.5 to 2 hours** here including stops and photos.



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Optional (Time Permitting): Museum Visit

If you have extra energy post-walk, you may visit one of these free, nearby museums:

1. [National Museum of Scotland](#) – Dinosaurs to Dolly the sheep
 10 AM – 5 PM |  Free
 ~25 mins from Dean Village
 2. [Scottish National Gallery](#) – Classic European art
 10 AM – 5 PM |  Free
 15 mins from Dean Village area
-

Meals

Lunch (Old Town near tour zone)

1. [The Caley Picture House](#) – Unique pub in an old cinema
 8 AM – 1 AM |  £10–18
Best for: Visual ambience, classic pub food
2. [Howies Victoria Street](#) – Fresh Scottish fare
 12:00 AM – 2:30 PM |  £15–25
 Must-try: Cullen Skink, cranachan

Dinner (Near Dean Village / New Town)

1. [The Hanging Bat](#) – Craft beer & comfort bites
 12 PM – 12 AM |  £15–20
 Try: Pulled pork sandwiches, loaded fries, local ales
 2. [ASK Italian](#) (*if not chosen earlier*)
 11:30 AM – 10 PM |  £15–25
Best for: Light pasta and relaxed dinner before heading back to Leith
-



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June 24 – Scenic Journey to Inverness & Victorian Market



Morning: Bus to Inverness

Today, you journey north into the majestic Scottish Highlands.



Departure Station: [Edinburgh Bus Station](#)



Arrival Station: [Inverness Bus Station](#)



Travel Time: ~4.5 hrs



Afternoon: Hotel Check-in & Victorian Market



Hotel: [1 Haugh Road, Ground Floor, Inverness, IV2 4SD](#)



Name: *Private Apartment – 1 Haugh Road, Inverness*



From bus station: ~13 min walk or 6 min taxi ride

Once you arrive and check in, stretch your legs with a visit to the charming [Victorian Market](#).



Open: 8 AM – 5:30 PM (most shops)



Highlights: Tartan scarves, Highland fudge, handmade soaps



Approx. 10 min walk from hotel

This indoor arcade offers a peek into Inverness's local craft and food scene under a cast-iron roof from the 1800s.



Evening: Riverside Stroll & Relaxed Dinner

As daylight softens, enjoy a walk along the tranquil [River Ness](#), lined with churches, swans, and historic bridges. If you're up for it, cross the **Infirmity Bridge** for postcard views of the cathedral and old town.



Meals



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Lunch (Upon Arrival in Inverness)

1. [The Kitchen Brasserie](#) – Modern riverside dining with large glass windows
 12 PM – 2:30 PM |  £15–25
 Try: Roast salmon, beetroot risotto, cranachan
Best for: Scenic Highlands-style lunch with elegant presentation
2. [Velocity Café & Bicycle Workshop](#) – Community café with a cozy, artsy vibe
 9 AM – 4 PM |  £8–15
 Try: Toasties, vegan brownies, locally roasted coffee
Best for: Relaxed, casual lunch with vegetarian options

Dinner (Inverness)

1. [The Mustard Seed Restaurant](#) – Upscale yet inviting, inside a converted church
 5 PM – 9:30 PM |  £20–30
 Must-try: Highland lamb, wild mushroom risotto, sticky toffee pudding
Best for: Refined Scottish dining with a cozy riverside view
 2. [Rocpool Restaurant](#) – Creative bistro-style dishes using local ingredients
 12 PM – 2 PM |  £25–35
 Try: Duck confit, scallops, raspberry cranachan
Best for: Stylish yet personal dining with excellent service
-



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June 25 – Steam Train Journey & Highland Landscapes



Morning: Day Trip Departure

Today you'll embark on one of Scotland's most scenic journeys — featuring a classic steam train and unforgettable Highland views.



Meeting Point: [19 Union Street, Inverness IV1 1QA](#)



Start Time: 9:30 AM - 9:00 PM



From your accommodation: ~8 mins on foot



Tip: Arrive by 9:15 AM to ensure check-in without rush

This **guided full-day excursion** (typically 12+ hours) will take you through rugged valleys, shimmering lochs, and remote Highland villages. The highlight? A ride on the **Jacobite Steam Train**, famed as the **Hogwarts Express** from the *Harry Potter* films, as it crosses the iconic **Glenfinnan Viaduct**.

Expect stops at:

- Fort William
- Mallaig (coastal fishing town)
- Glenfinnan Viewpoint
- Photo ops along Loch Shiel and mountain passes



Bring: A warm jacket, comfortable walking shoes, and a backup phone charger



Snacks: You may wish to pack extras or pick some up during stops



Evening: Return to Inverness

You'll return to Inverness in the evening, typically between 8:00 PM and 9:00 PM depending on traffic and tour duration. Expect to be dropped off at or near your original meeting point.

After such a rich and immersive day, dinner will be casual and close to home.



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Meals

Lunch (During Tour – usually in Mallaig)

These two venues are commonly recommended and easily reachable from the train stop in Mallaig:

1. [The Tea Garden Café](#) – Homey seaside café
 10 AM – 4 PM |  £10–15
 Try: Fish and chips, Cullen Skink, homemade pies
Best for: Local charm and freshly made Scottish comfort food
2. [Cornerstone Restaurant](#) – Seafood with harbour views
 12 PM – 2:30 PM |  £15–25
 Must-try: Grilled langoustines, crab salad, sticky toffee pudding
Best for: Regional seafood and a more refined sit-down lunch

Dinner (Back in Inverness, near hotel)

1. [Black Isle Bar & Rooms](#) – Pizza & craft beer spot with rooftop seating
 12 PM – 12 AM |  £12–18
 Try: Wood-fired pizzas, wild mushroom toppings, IPA tastings
Best for: Laid-back post-adventure dinner with local brews
 2. [River House Restaurant](#) – Intimate seafood & grill on the river
 9 AM – 11 PM |  £25–35
 Must-try: Highland venison, grilled seabass, wine pairings
Best for: Elegant wind-down meal with a serene riverside view
-



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June 26 – Isle of Skye Wonders & Natural Majesty



Morning: Departure for Skye Day Tour

Today is your Highland epic — an unforgettable loop through one of Scotland's most iconic landscapes: the mystical [Isle of Skye](#).



Meeting Point: [19 Union Street, Inverness IV1 1QA](#)



Start Time: 7:45 AM - 8:00 PM (arrive by 7:30 am)



~8 mins from your accommodation by foot



What to bring:

- Layers (weather can shift quickly)
- Water, light snacks, power bank
- Camera with space for wide landscapes!

This **full-day guided tour** showcases:

- **Eilean Donan Castle** – Scotland's most photographed fortress (photo stop)
- **Skye Bridge** – dramatic crossing onto the island
- **Portree** – charming pastel harbour village (lunch stop)
- **Old Man of Storr, Kilt Rock, Quiraing**, and more – jaw-dropping natural scenery

You'll be treated to dramatic sea cliffs, rolling moors, and tales of faeries and Viking legends — all from the comfort of a minivan, with plenty of photo stops.



Evening: Return to Inverness

Expect to arrive back in the city between **8:00 PM – 8:30 PM**, depending on weather and road conditions. You'll be dropped off near your original pickup location.



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Meals

Lunch (in Portree, Isle of Skye)

1. [Café Arriba](#) – Funky, colorful hillside café with island comfort food
 8 AM – 5 PM |  £10–18
 Try: Chicken & haggis panini, lentil soup, whisky cheesecake
Best for: Cozy atmosphere with a view over the harbour
2. [The Lower Deck Seafood Restaurant](#) – Local shellfish in a nautical setting
 12 PM – 3 PM |  £15–25
 Try: Mussels, langoustines, Isle of Skye scallops
Best for: Fresh-caught seafood lunch right by the water

Dinner (Back in Inverness)

1. [MacGregor's Bar](#) – Live music, Highland ales, and hearty pub fare
 12 PM – 11 PM |  £15–20
 Must-try: mac 'n' cheese, local beer flights
Best for: Lively, rustic local vibe to end your day
 2. [Prime Steak & Seafood](#) – Upmarket grillhouse for a slow, celebratory dinner
 5 PM – 9:30 PM |  £25–35
 Try: grilled prawns, sticky toffee pudding
Best for: Refined service and well-executed classics
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June 27 – Departure Day: Inverness to London via Edinburgh



Morning: Train from Inverness to Edinburgh

Today marks the end of your Highlands escape. After breakfast and check-out, make your way to the train station for your southbound journey.



Departure Station: [Inverness Railway Station](#)



Arrival Station: [Edinburgh Waverley Station](#)



Duration: Approx. 3 hrs 27 mins



Tip: Check ScotRail schedules for direct morning departures that align comfortably with your onward train to London

Enjoy one final scenic ride through the Scottish Highlands, watching mist-topped hills and lochs give way to the bustling capital below.



Afternoon: Train Transfer from Edinburgh to London

Upon arrival at **Edinburgh Waverley**, follow signs for your connection toward London. You'll transfer onto a high-speed train (likely LNER or Avanti West Coast) bound for **London King's Cross**.



Typical travel time: ~5 hrs 5 mins



Arrival Station: [London King's Cross Station](#)



Luggage tip: Waverley Station offers left-luggage services if there's downtime between trains

This leg brings you back to the heart of England, capping off a journey filled with ancient castles, steam trains, lochs, and literary magic.



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Instagrammable Cafés & Restaurants

Edinburgh – Leith Zone (Wester Harbour)

1. [Dishoom Edinburgh](#) – Bombay nostalgia meets modern style
 Retro interiors, hanging lights, and signature House Chai
 2. [The Caley Picture House](#) – A Wetherspoon pub inside a converted cinema
 Art deco dome, balcony seating, and cinematic grandeur
 3. [The Pantry Stockbridge](#) – Brunch perfection in a botanical-themed café
 White-tiled walls, fresh pastries, and latte art
 4. [Cairngorm Coffee Co.](#) – Modern minimalism meets craft coffee
 Warm wood tones, local art, and photogenic flat whites
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Must-Try Local Dishes (and Where to Eat Them)

Street Food & Snacks

- **Cullen Skink** – A creamy smoked haddock chowder
📍 Try it at [Howies Victoria Street](#)
 - **Scottish Tablet** – Buttery, crumbly fudge-like sweet
📍 Buy from souvenir shops along the [Royal Mile](#)
-

Main Dishes

- **Haggis, Neeps & Tatties** – A national icon, served with turnips and mash
📍 [Makars Mash Bar](#)
 - **Highland Venison** – Rich, local meat served with seasonal veg
📍 [River House Restaurant](#)
 - **Seafood Linguine or Langoustines** – West coast freshness on your plate
📍 [Cornerstone Restaurant, Mallaig](#)
-

Desserts & Drinks

- **Cranachan** – Whipped cream, raspberries, honey, and oats
📍 [The Kitchen Brasserie, Inverness](#)
 - **Sticky Toffee Pudding** – A rich, treacle-glazed classic
📍 [The Mustard Seed, Inverness](#)
 - **Scotch Whisky Tasting**
📍 [Whiski Bar & Restaurant](#)
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Important Places Around Hotels



Edinburgh – Residence Inn by Marriott



Quartermile, 36 Simpson Loan, Edinburgh EH3 9GG, United Kingdom



Groceries & Convenience

1. [Quartermile Campus Family Mart](#)



9am- 10pm (opens at 11am on Sat and Sun)



1 min walk

2. [Sainsbury's Local](#)



7am- 10pm (opens at 8am on Sat and Sun)



2 min walk



Pharmacies

1. [Right Medicine Pharmacy](#)



Mon–Fri: 9 AM – 1 PM; 2PM- 6PM; Sat (9am- 1pm); Sun- closed



5 min walk



Inverness – 1 Haugh Road, Ground Floor



1 Haugh Road, IV2 4SD, Inverness



Groceries & Convenience

1. [Co-op Food – Dalneigh Road](#)



7 AM – 10 PM



+44 1463 232191



6 min car drive

2. [Tesco Express – Glenurquhart Road](#)



7 AM – 11 PM



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 +44 345 671 9281
 ~8-min walk

Pharmacies

1. [Superdrug Pharmacy](#)

 8:30 AM – 7 PM
 ~6 min walk

2. [Boots Pharmacy](#)

 9 AM – 6 PM
 ~3 min car drive



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Souvenir Shopping Guide



Edible Keepsakes

1. **Tunnock's Tea Cakes** – Iconic Scottish marshmallow biscuits covered in chocolate
 Buy from: Supermarkets like [Tesco](#), [Sainsbury's](#), and Co-op
 Lightweight and travel-safe
 2. **Shortbread** – Buttery traditional Scottish cookies
 Available at: [Royal Mile souvenir shops](#), [Walker's stores](#), and all major supermarkets
 3. **Sticky Toffee Pudding (packaged)**
 Buy from: M&S Food, Waitrose, or [Sainsbury's](#) near your Edinburgh or Inverness accommodation
-



Whisky & Tartan Items

1. **Scotch Whisky** – From single malts to blends, a true taste of Scotland
 Top shops:
 - [The Scotch Whisky Experience](#) – Royal Mile
 - [Royal Mile Whiskies](#) – Expert-led shop with rare labels
 2. **Tartan Scarves & Kilts** – Emblems of Scottish clan pride and design
 Available at:
 - [Heritage of Scotland](#) – Large Royal Mile retailer
 - [Highland House of Fraser, Inverness](#) – Authentic goods and custom options
 3. **Whisky Stones / Rocks** – Reusable chilling stones for neat whisky drinkers
 Find in: Edinburgh souvenir shops or whisky specialty stores
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Classic Travel Souvenirs

1. **Magnets, Mugs, and Miniature Castles** – Featuring landmarks like the Edinburgh Castle, Loch Ness, and Glenfinnan Viaduct



Best zones:

- [Royal Mile](#) – Endless variety and quick comparisons
- [Waverley Mall](#) – Near station for last-minute buys

2. **Scottish Fudge & Tablet** – Sweet, crumbly, and rich — perfect gifts



Local confectionery stores and most supermarkets



Tips for Shopping in Scotland

-  **Receipts:** Request VAT refund receipts if shopping from tax-free eligible vendors
 -  **Pack light:** Leave some luggage space for edible items and boxed spirits
 -  **Card over cash:** Most vendors accept contactless payments, even in smaller markets
 -  **Check airline rules** for packing liquid items like whisky in checked luggage
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Cultural Etiquette & Useful Local Phrases



Social & Cultural Norms

- **Politeness goes far:** Saying “*please*”, “*thank you*”, and “*sorry*” frequently is the norm — even for minor situations like bumping into someone or asking for help.
 - **Queueing is sacred:** The British (and Scots) take turns seriously. Always wait your turn in lines, whether for buses, counters, or cafés.
 - **Tipping etiquette:**
 - Restaurants: 10–12% is appreciated for sit-down meals (check if service charge is included).
 - Taxis: Round up to the nearest pound.
 - Tours: Optional but appreciated if service was exceptional.
 - **Driving rules:** Even as a passenger, it’s helpful to know — traffic moves on the **left**, and pedestrians should look **right** before crossing.
 - **Volume & tone:** In public settings like trains or museums, locals tend to speak in softer tones.
-



Temple or Historic Site Etiquette

- Remove hats in cathedrals and chapels unless part of religious attire.
 - Photography may be restricted in certain sacred or historical spaces — look for signs or ask staff.
 - Speak softly and keep phones on silent when touring solemn sites like **St. Giles’ Cathedral** or inside castle chapels.
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Useful Local Phrases

General British English

- **“Cheers”** – Means thanks (also used when toasting)
- **“Sorry, could you help me with...?”** – Polite opener for any request
- **“Mind the gap”** – Watch your step (commonly heard in train stations)
- **“Loo”** – Bathroom / toilet
- **“I’ll have a flat white, please”** – Common café order (type of coffee)

Scottish Vernacular (a light touch for fun)

- **“Aye”** – Yes
 - **“Nae bother”** – No problem / you’re welcome
 - **“Bonnie”** – Beautiful
 - **“Wee”** – Small (e.g., “a wee dram” = a small whisky)
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BON VOYAGE BY MARINA

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Contact Number: +91-86000-15316

Email ID: hello@bonvoyagebymarina.com



Packing List (Summer – June Travel)



Essentials

- Lightweight layers (temperatures range 10–20°C / 50–68°F)
- Waterproof jacket or windbreaker – sudden showers are common
- Comfortable walking shoes – cobbled streets & light hikes
- Daypack for excursions
- Sunglasses, hat & compact umbrella



For Specific Activities

- Warm jumper or fleece for Highland train and Isle of Skye tours
- Swimsuit & quick-dry towel (for optional wild swim stops or spa)
- Refillable water bottle



Health & Safety

- Basic first-aid kit: plasters, antiseptic wipes, motion sickness tablets
 - Mosquito repellent (for countryside)
 - Prescribed medications + copy of your prescription
-



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Personal Safety & Emergency Contacts



General Safety Tips

- Scotland is generally safe, but:
 - Watch belongings in busy areas (e.g., Royal Mile)
 - Use well-lit paths when walking after dark
 - Avoid swimming in lochs unless guided — water temps remain cold even in summer



Emergency Numbers

- Police/Medical/Fire: **999**
- NHS 24-hour medical help: **111**
- Non-emergency police: **101**



Hospitals Nearby

- **Edinburgh:** [Chalmers Centre](#) – Minor injuries
- **Inverness:** [Raigmore Hospital](#) – Major emergency and medical care



Indian Embassy in the UK

- **Edinburgh Consulate:** +44 131 229 2144
 - **Emergency London line:** +44 (0)7768 765035
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Mobile Connectivity & SIM Guide

Best SIM Options

- **Three UK** – Best for data-heavy usage and coverage across Highlands
- **O2** and **EE** – Reliable urban and rural reach
- **Vodafone** – Strong in cities, patchier in remote Skye areas

Where to Buy

- Kiosks at **Edinburgh Waverley Station**, **airports**, or **local Carphone Warehouse**
- Bring passport/ID for SIM card registration

Coverage Tips

- 4G widely available in cities, **intermittent on Isle of Skye and remote Highland routes**
 - Most tour operators offer emergency contact numbers if cell signal drops
-



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Health & Vaccination Recommendations



Vaccines

- No special vaccines required for Scotland
- Make sure these are up-to-date:
 - Tetanus
 - Hepatitis A
 - Typhoid (recommended for countryside stays or extended travel)



Other Tips

- Carry **mosquito repellent**
 - Hand sanitizer for travel days
 - Water is safe to drink – refills are fine in tap water or mountain springs (unless posted otherwise)
-



Thank You!

Thank you for giving us the opportunity to plan your vacation. We hope you fully enjoy your vacation and make unforgettable memories for a lifetime!

Don't forget, we're just a message or call away for any assistance you may need, whether it's before, during, or after your trip.

Bon Voyage By Marina - +91-86000-15316
